Colour Studies

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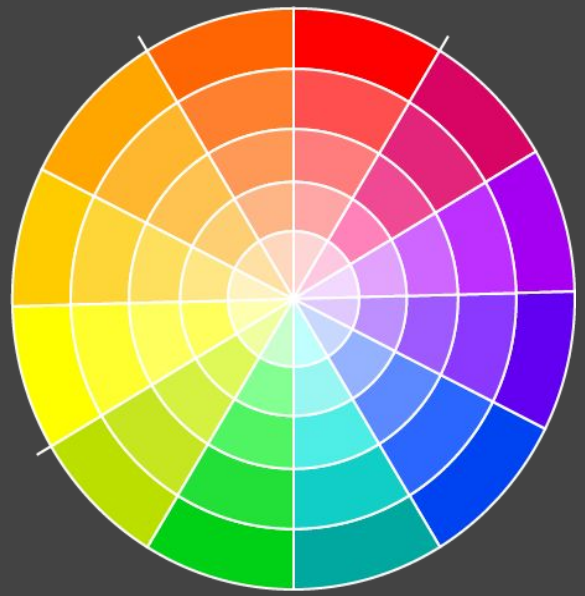
What is Colour?



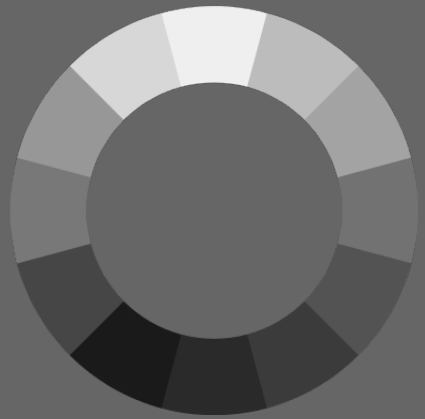
Colour is how we see light. Different colours appear because light bounces off objects in different ways. Colours have three parts:

- Hue – the name of the colour (like red, blue, green)
- Saturation – how strong or faded the colour is
- Brightness – how light or dark the colour is

We use colour to express ideas, show emotion, and create style in art and design.

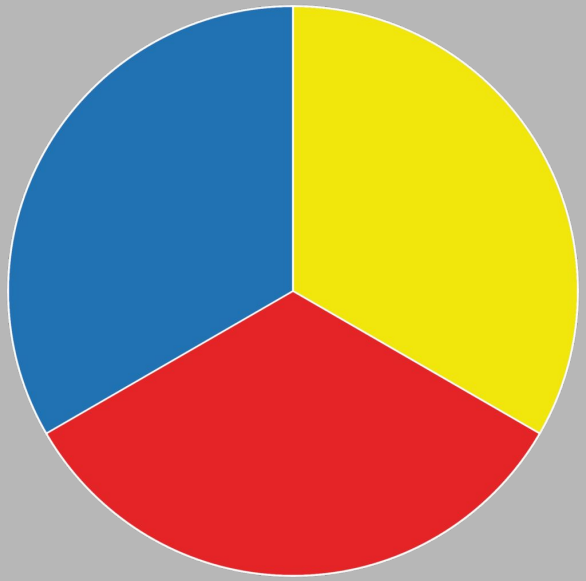
Monochromatic & Achromatic Colours

Monochromatic colours are different versions of one colour. You get them by adding white (to make it lighter), black (to make it darker), or grey (to tone it down).



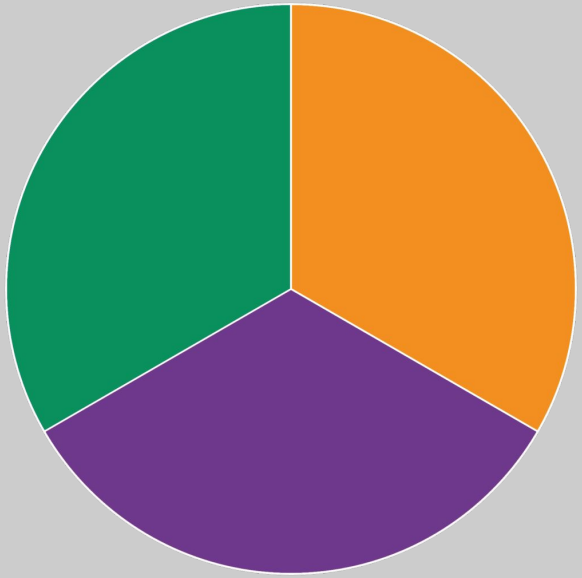
Achromatic colours have no colour at all. They are black, white, and greys. These colours feel neutral and clean, and go well with everything.

Primary Colours



Primary colours are red, blue, and yellow. These are the three colours you can't make by mixing others. They are the base colours used to make all the rest. Every colour on the colour wheel comes from mixing these.

Secondary Colours



Secondary colours are made by mixing two primary colours:

- Red + Yellow = Orange
- Blue + Yellow = Green
- Red + Blue = Purple

These are the next level of colours and are used all the time in art and design.

Tertiary Colours

Tertiary colours are made by mixing a primary colour with a secondary one. Some examples are:

- Red + Orange = Red-orange
- Blue + Green = Blue-green

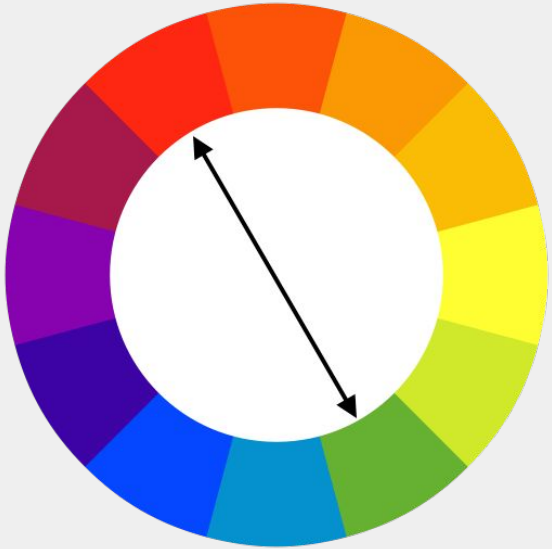
These colours have more interesting tones and are often used to add detail and variety.

Complementary Colours

Complementary colours are opposite each other on the colour wheel. They are very different, so when you use them together, they stand out and look bold.
Examples:

- Red and Green
- Blue and Orange
- Yellow and Purple

They're great for eye-catching designs or making something pop.



Thank you!

NOTE: The backgrounds in this presentation slides move from black to white — a subtle use of **achromatic colours**, showing how colour can speak, even without colour.